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VOL. 14 · ST. PATRICK WEST

The Foreign Minister's Parish: How the NNP Fell Behind in St. Patrick West

Joseph Andall won St. Patrick West by 268 votes in 2022. Four years as Foreign Minister later, he won by 1,160. The NNP's share fell 13 points, faster than the national swing, and it did not carry one of 16 polling divisions.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. PATRICK WEST, GRENADA

ST. PATRICK WEST, GRENADA—St. Patrick West, covering Sauteurs, Chantimelle, Mount Rich, Hermitage, Fond, Prospect and Samaritan, was won by the NDC's Joseph Andall in 2022 by 1,726 votes to 1,458 for the NNP's Victor Philip, a margin of 268. The NNP had held the seat through Anthony Boatswain until he stood down before that election.

> **"A senior minister who works his seat can turn a narrow win into a fortress in one term."**
> GREG HOSTEN

On 5 November Mr. Andall, by then Grenada's Foreign Minister, won again by 2,245 votes to 1,085 for the NNP's Jelani Glean, with 53 for the DPM's Andy Best. His majority more than quadrupled.

A MINISTER AT HOME

Mr. Andall is one of the most senior figures in the NDC. He was the party's acting leader after the 2018 defeat, and since July 2022 he has been Minister of Foreign Affairs, Trade and Export Development. In 2026 he stood as a sitting Cabinet minister with four years in the seat.

His vote rose by 519, the largest increase of any NDC incumbent in the St. Patrick and St. Andrew seats. His share of the whole electorate rose from 37.0 per cent of registered voters to 42.9 per cent. A senior minister who also works his seat is the hardest kind of opponent there is.

A CARETAKER NAMED IN APRIL 2025

The NNP named Mr. Glean as its caretaker for St. Patrick West in April 2025, alongside new caretakers for St. David, St. George South and St. Andrew South West. Like them, he had about 19 months before polling day.

In every one of those four seats the NNP's share of the two-party vote fell by around the national swing or more. In St. Patrick West it fell from 45.8 per cent to 32.6 per cent, a drop of 13.2 points, the third-largest fall in the country after St. Mark and St. George South.

NOT ONE DIVISION

The NNP did not carry any of the 16 polling divisions. Its best results were at the Chantimelle R.C. School, with 41.3 per cent of the two-party vote across two divisions, and at the Hermitage S.D.A. Church, with 39.9 per cent. At Mount Rich it took 36.6 per cent.

Sauteurs and its surroundings went heavily to the NDC. At the St. Patrick's R.C. School the NNP took 19.1 per cent, 36 votes to 152. At the TAMCC campus, across three divisions, it took 26.0 per cent. At Samaritan, 22.0 per cent. At Prospect, 30.3 per cent.

THE SHAPE OF THE CHANGE

The NNP's vote fell by 373, from 1,458 to 1,085. The register grew by 560, and 102 more ballots were cast. Turnout fell from 70.4 per cent to 64.8 per cent.

Unlike several seats where the NDC simply held its share while the NNP's support stayed home, here the NDC grew. Its gain of 519 votes was larger than the NNP's loss. Some of it came from new voters, and some, very likely, from NNP voters who switched.

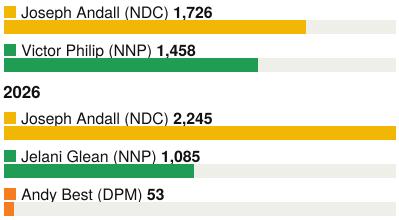
FIVE HUNDRED AND EIGHTY-ONE VOTERS

To win the seat back, the NNP needs 581 voters to switch sides, or 1,161 more of its own supporters to turn out, nearly two-thirds of those who stayed home. Against a senior minister, that is not a realistic target for a single election.

But the seat was won by the NNP as recently as 2018, and it was close in 2022. Recovering the 2022 vote of 1,458 would cut

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



1,160 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

1,160
NDC winning margin, up from 268 in 2022

0 of 16
Polling divisions won by the NNP

–13.2 pts
Fall in the NNP's two-party share, worse than nationally

+519
Rise in the NDC vote, the incumbent's gain

the margin by about a third and put the party back in contention for the election after next.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A PLAN FOR ST. PATRICK WEST

St. Patrick West needs patience, presence and a candidate who stays.

Year one, 2027: confirm the candidate and commit to two elections. Open a permanent office in Sauteurs, the parish town, where the NNP is currently weakest.

Year two, 2028: build from Chantimelle, Hermitage and Mount Rich, where the NNP did best. Hold regular meetings with fishers and vendors in Sauteurs, farmers in the hills and students and staff at the TAMCC campus.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 16 divisions. Hold the Foreign Minister to account on what St. Patrick West itself has received during his term, in roads, water and jobs, measured against his promises.

Year four, 2030: set realistic targets. Win the first polling division, at Chantimelle or Hermitage. Restore the 2022 vote of 1,458. Lift the NNP's share of the two-party vote above 40 per cent.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

A senior minister who works his seat can turn a narrow win into a fortress in one term. Mr. Andall did that in St. Patrick West. The NNP cannot match a Cabinet minister's profile, but it can match his presence, if it starts early and keeps the same candidate in place.

St. Patrick West will not be the first seat the NNP wins back. It can be one of the seats where the party stops falling.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. PATRICK WEST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	1,458	1,085	−373
NDC votes	1,726	2,245	+519
NNP share of two-party vote	45.8%	32.6%	−13.2 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NDC +268	NDC +1,160	
Registered voters	4,668	5,228	+560
Turnout	70.4%	64.8%	−5.6 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,380	1,838	+458
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	31.2%	20.8%	−10.4 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		0 of 16	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		581	

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates (2022: Independent 86, GULP 9; 2026: DPM 53). 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 16 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. A working minister is the hardest opponent: match his presence, not his title.
2. Name the caretaker early: 19 months was not enough.
3. Open a permanent office in Sauteurs, where the NNP is weakest.
4. Build from Chantimelle, Hermitage and Mount Rich.
5. Engage TAMCC students and staff in the St. Patrick campus divisions.
6. Hold the Foreign Minister to account on local delivery.
7. Captain all 16 divisions and win the first one.
8. Restore the 2022 vote of 1,458 as the first milestone.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2008, 2013 and 2022 general elections; Joseph Andall); NOW Grenada (Boatswain not contesting, Jan 2021; NNP caretakers, Apr 2025; 2026 results). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 14 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.